

Standard Operating Procedure: Monthly Cloud Threat Intelligence Briefing in Manus

Document purpose: Enable a user with a Manus account, but no prior experience of Manus skills or presentation creation, to produce a one-slide, source-supported Cloud Threat Intelligence Briefing for a Group CRO and Risk Committee.

Operating model: Build two personal skills once, invoke them in each run, direct Manus through evidence collection and quality controls, and receive a PowerPoint-compatible one-slide artefact. The process supports a normal single-month run and a manually specified connected period such as **July-August 2026**.

Control objective: Convert cloud, identity, delivery-platform and enterprise-edge threat evidence into a concise 2LoD risk conclusion. Separate source-supported facts from internal assessment. Keep all source traceability in speaker notes and internal working files, not on the slide.

1. Scope, Roles and Deliverables

Item	Standard
Primary user	Cyber Risk Intelligence specialist, 2LoD cyber-risk team, or equivalent governance function.
Audience	Group CRO, Risk Committee and senior banking executives.
Standard reporting window	The immediately preceding calendar month.
Exception reporting window	Explicitly name the full start and end dates in the run prompt, for example 1 July 2026 to 31 August 2026 .
Output	One 16:9 PowerPoint-compatible slide, with speaker notes.
On-slide content	Executive conclusion, material incidents or vectors, systemic-risk translation, CVE tracking table and three 2LoD directives.
Off-slide content	Reporting period, evidence cut-off, URLs, sources, claim IDs, caveats and prior-period

	correction. These remain in an Internal evidence register in speaker notes.
Evidence standard	At least one primary or authoritative source for every material assertion, or two credible corroborating sources where no primary source exists.

The briefing is not an incident report, vulnerability digest or technology-news summary. It retains only evidence that can create a plausible material pathway to disruption, unauthorised access, data exposure, compromised software delivery, third-party concentration, or regulatory response.

2. One-Time Setup: Create the Two Personal Skills

Create the skills once. They should then be available for later runs as personal skills. Do this in a **new Manus task** before producing the first briefing.

2.1 Create the Governance Writing-Control Skill

Start a new task and paste the following prompt exactly. The task will create a downloadable personal skill package. Add that package to your skills when Manus presents it.

Plain Text

```
Create a personal Manus skill named `risk-committee-writing-controls`.

Purpose: apply mandatory language, evidence and formatting controls to every Ri

Create a valid skill package with:
1. `SKILL.md`.
2. `scripts/check_language_controls.py`.

The skill must contain these mandatory controls:
- Do not use the four prohibited risk adjectives defined in this approved polic
- Do not use an em dash. Use a spaced hyphen: ` - `.
- Separate observed facts, 2LoD assessment, and plausible scenario.
- State materiality with exploitation status, privilege, reachability, common-m
- Do not assert bank impact, loss, regulatory duty, attribution, exploitation o
- Do not allow citations, dates, audience labels, sources, URLs, reporting-peri
- Require the language checker to be run against the pre-generation draft, fina

The Python checker must exit non-zero when it finds a prohibited term in visibl
```

Keep the skill concise, write it in imperative form, validate it, and deliver it

Use the following acceptance test after the skill is delivered. Start a fresh task and enter the text below. Manus should recognise and apply the installed skill.

Plain Text

Using my `risk-committee-writing-controls` skill, review this text and return o

The expected correction removes the prohibited descriptor and substitutes the em dash with a spaced hyphen. If the correction does not happen, re-open the creation task, ask Manus to amend the skill, and reinstall the updated package.

2.2 Create the Monthly Cloud Threat Briefing Skill

Start a second new Manus task and paste the following prompt exactly. It creates the workflow skill used to control research, 2LoD translation, slide content and delivery.

Plain Text

Create a personal Manus skill named `monthly-cloud-threat-briefing`.

Use it when producing a one-slide monthly Cloud Threat Intelligence Briefing fo

Create a valid skill package with:

1. `SKILL.md`.
2. `references/slide-layout.md`.
3. `references/run-playbook.md`.

The skill must enforce the following workflow.

Purpose and scope:

- Produce one 16:9 executive PowerPoint-compatible slide for a stated reporting
- Include only material cloud-related activity relevant to a global bank: cloud
- Retain only active exploitation, known-exploited CVEs, unauthenticated remote
- Exclude generic phishing, ordinary ransomware, low-impact CVEs, undated comme

Evidence rules:

- Derive the previous calendar month by default; accept an explicitly specified
- Research six streams in parallel: exploited cloud and enterprise-edge CVEs; c
- Prioritise cloud-provider and vendor advisories, CISA KEV, CVE/NVD records, C
- Maintain an internal source register and claim ledger with finding ID, event
- Distinguish event date from publication date and evidence cut-off.
- Do not state exploitation, financial loss, attribution, bank exposure or regu

2LoD translation:

- Translate technical vector to operational vulnerability.
- Translate exploitation method to systemic or concentration risk.
- Translate threat actor objective to geopolitical or macro-financial threat.
- Translate immediate technical effect to material financial and regulatory impact.
- Challenge 1LoD assumptions on patching delay, internet exposure, identity governance.
- State RAF alignment only when a defined control condition supports it; otherwise not.

Slide rules:

- Use exactly these zones: Executive Summary; Threat Landscape & Primary Incidents; Recommendations.
- Title must be `CLOUD THREAT INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING`; do not display report date.
- Use a white 16:9 canvas, Inter font, emerald green `#00875A` for title, headings.
- Executive Summary: 25-35 words.
- Primary incidents: two to three only; 35-45 words per incident.
- Systemic-risk narrative: 70-90 words.
- Use a table when at least one material CVE qualifies. It must have exactly four columns.
- Use three stacked recommendation boxes. Each box has an emerald-green header.
- Speaker notes must include `Internal evidence register`, reporting period, evidence.

Quality gates:

- Check reporting-period relevance, source quality, materiality, separation of concerns.
- Run the language checker before slide generation and after generation on the slides.
- Render or present the finished slide and confirm that all content lies inside the slide.
- Deliver only the presentation slide unless supporting evidence is requested.

Write concise imperative instructions. Keep detailed layout rules in `reference`.

2.3 Confirm the Installed Skills

Before the first production run, start a new task and paste the following prompt.

Plain Text

Confirm that the personal skills `monthly-cloud-threat-briefing` and `risk-comm

If both names are returned, continue. If a skill is unavailable, add the delivered package to personal skills and start a new task again. Do not rely on a skill created in an earlier task until its package has been added to your personal skill library.

3. Monthly Operating Procedure

Step 1 - Open a Fresh Production Task

Create a new Manus task for each reporting cycle. A fresh task reduces accidental reuse of prior-period evidence and makes the evidence cut-off auditable.

Use one of the following prompts.

Run type	Prompt
Standard monthly run	Run the Monthly Cloud Threat Intelligence Briefing for the previous calendar month. Conduct wide research, validate every material claim, apply the 2LoD translation framework and risk-committee-writing-controls, and produce one PowerPoint slide using the prescribed executive layout. Retain only material cloud incidents and CVEs. Do not show citations, sources, reporting-period labels or audience labels on the slide. Deliver only after source, language, content, layout and PowerPoint quality checks pass.
Connected two-month run	Run the Monthly Cloud Threat Intelligence Briefing for the connected reporting period 1 July 2026 to 31 August 2026. Treat both months as one integrated risk pattern, not two separate summaries. Conduct wide research, validate every material claim, apply the 2LoD translation framework and risk-committee-writing-controls, and produce one PowerPoint slide using the prescribed executive layout. Retain only material cloud incidents and CVEs. Do not show citations, sources, reporting-period labels or audience labels on the slide. Deliver only after source, language, content, layout and PowerPoint quality checks pass.

Always state the dates when producing a non-standard period. The original monthly default is designed for one preceding month and will not infer a two-month boundary reliably.

Step 2 - Require a Run Manifest Before Research

Ask Manus to create an internal run manifest. It must contain the period, time of run, evidence cut-off, intended audience, output constraints and six research streams. It is a working control, not a slide element.

Plain Text

Before research, create an internal run manifest with: reporting period; curren

Step 3 - Execute Wide Research Across Six Streams

Direct Manus to research each stream independently and retain URLs and dates. The required input list is fixed below.

Stream	What to identify	Preferred evidence
Exploited cloud and enterprise-edge CVEs	KEV additions, vendor-confirmed exploitation, internet-facing administrative exposure.	CISA KEV, vendor security advisories, CVE/NVD, CERT.
Cloud-provider and SaaS advisories	Control-plane events, material service incidents, shared-provider exposure, provider remediation.	Provider advisory, service status report, incident report.
Identity and non-human identity	Federated identity, OAuth/OIDC, service account, API key, secret, privileged automation and token weakness.	Vendor advisory, CERT, government research.
API, container and orchestration	API gateway, Kubernetes, container, service mesh, serverless, SD-WAN and cloud-network management exposure.	Vendor advisory, CISA, engineering incident report.
CI/CD and software supply chain	Package, signing, trusted publishing, runner, build server, artifact repository and dependency compromise.	Maintainer advisory, provider incident report, CISA.
Threat actor and systemic context	Campaigns targeting cloud tenants or administration, common providers and material concentration pathways.	Government, law enforcement, credible threat research.

Use this control prompt immediately after the run manifest.

Plain Text

Research the six required streams independently. For every retained finding, re

Step 4 - Apply the Materiality Filter and Claim Ledger

Do not place every discovered CVE on the slide. Retain an item only when it meets at least one materiality condition.

Materiality condition	Inclusion decision
Active exploitation, KEV listing, confirmed weaponisation or live campaign	Retain when the technology is cloud, identity, enterprise edge, CI/CD or a relevant shared dependency.
Shared control plane or common provider	Retain when failure can reach multiple workloads, clients, applications or suppliers.
Unauthenticated remote access or code execution	Retain when reachability and privilege make the pathway material.
Privileged persistence, cross-tenant failure or compromise of administrative, payment, customer or material-data services	Retain if the evidence is authoritative.
High CVSS score without exploitability or concentration context	Do not retain solely for the score.
Generic threat commentary or a low-impact product defect	Exclude.

Create a claim ledger before drafting. Ask Manus to provide it internally, not on the slide.

Plain Text

Create an internal claim ledger for the shortlisted findings. Separate: source-

Step 5 - Translate into 2LoD Risk Language

Use the following translation structure. The slide must state the evidence first and the bank-relevant conclusion second.

Evidence input	Required 2LoD expression
Technical vector	Operational vulnerability.

Exploitation method	Systemic or concentration risk.
Threat actor objective	Geopolitical or macro-financial threat.
Immediate technical effect	Material financial and regulatory impact.

Use the following drafting pattern for each retained item.

Plain Text

Observed fact: [source-supported product, exploitability, scope and date].

Operational vulnerability: [control weakness that permits the outcome].

2LoD assessment: [shared control-plane, common-provider, privileged-path or thi

Potential material consequence: [business-service disruption, unauthorised acce

Limitation: [what the public evidence does not establish].

Do not state that the bank was affected unless a bank-owned source establishes it. Do not convert a vendor advisory into a statement of loss, customer impact, supervisory action or attribution without evidence.

Step 6 - Draft the Slide Content Before Creating the Slide

Ask Manus for a plain-text slide draft and apply the language controls before slide generation. The prompt below is designed for the one-slide format.

Plain Text

Using only the approved claim ledger, draft the content for one executive slide

- Title: CLOUD THREAT INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING.
- Executive Summary: 25-35 words stating the connected conclusion, systemic imp
- Left column: Threat Landscape & Primary Incidents. Use two source-supported m
- Right column: Systemic Risk Impact & Strategic Recommendations. Write 70-90 w
- Add Critical Vulnerability Tracking if one or more CVEs qualify. Use exactly
- Add three action boxes, each with a 20-30 word body and outcome-led directive
- Add speaker notes headed `Internal evidence register` with reporting period,
- Do not add source references, dates, reporting-period labels, audience labels

Run the risk-committee language checker on the draft. Correct every finding bef

Step 7 - Create the PowerPoint Slide

After the draft passes language control, ask Manus to create the slide. This prompt prevents unwanted cover pages, appendices, sources and decorative additions.

Plain Text

Create exactly one 16:9 PowerPoint-compatible slide from the approved draft. Us

The visible slide should follow this layout.

Zone	Required treatment
Title	Top-left uppercase title only.
Executive Summary	Full-width emerald-green banner below the title. White text.
Left column	Heading, up to two metrics, and two material incident narratives.
Right column	Heading and systemic-risk narrative.
Vulnerability table	Below the right-column narrative. Omit only where no qualifying CVE exists.
Recommendation boxes	Three stacked boxes below the table. Emerald-green headers, white body fields.

Step 8 - Add Notes, Test and Deliver

If the generated slide does not include speaker notes, use this prompt.

Plain Text

Add concise presenter notes to the slide. Include an `Internal evidence registe

Finally, ask Manus to complete the release checks and present the presentation.

Plain Text

Complete final quality assurance. Confirm that there is one slide only; that no

4. Mandatory Quality Gates

A briefing is not ready for distribution unless every gate below passes.

Gate	Pass criterion	Required remediation if failed
Reporting period	Every retained event is inside the stated date range, or identified as a prior-period correction.	Remove it, relabel it as a correction in notes, or re-run research.
Evidence	Every material visible claim has primary authoritative evidence, or two credible corroborating sources.	Omit or rewrite the claim.
Materiality	Every incident or CVE has exploitation, control-plane, privilege, reachability or concentrated-dependency relevance.	Exclude low-value items.
Claim discipline	Facts and 2LoD assessment are distinct.	Prefix internal conclusion with 2LoD assessment: and remove unsupported factual wording.
Slide schema	One slide; required title, banner, two columns, table where relevant and three action boxes.	Rework the slide.
Vulnerability table	Exact headings, no blank rows and no CVSS value without a source.	Correct table entries.
Visible-slide exclusions	No sources, citations, URLs, dates, reporting period, audience label, logo or footer.	Remove from visible content and retain in notes.
Language	The controlled-language check passes on draft, slide source and speaker notes.	Correct the flagged wording and repeat the check.
Notes	Internal evidence register includes period, cut-off, sources, IDs, limitations and corrections.	Rebuild notes.
Layout	Content is legible, within the canvas, aligned, non-	Rebalance dimensions, font size and content density.

overlapping and table text is readable.

5. Exception Handling and Troubleshooting

Situation	Required response
A material event is reported after the reporting cut-off	Record it as a Prior-period correction in the next run. Refresh the prior slide only if it changes the connected risk conclusion.
An authoritative source is inaccessible	Use a second authoritative record, an official mirror, an original vendor advisory or a government alert. Do not rely on a search-result summary.
A source confirms a flaw but not active exploitation	Describe it as disclosed or remediated. Do not label it exploited.
A CVSS score cannot be corroborated	Write Not published in the table and preserve the limitation in notes.
More than three plausible incidents qualify	Select the two or three with the clearest shared control-plane pathway. Retain the remaining validated items in the internal ledger.
No CVE qualifies	Omit the vulnerability table and redistribute space to systemic-risk narrative and recommendations.
The language check fails because an original source title contains a prohibited expression	Paraphrase the title in notes and retain only the URL and claim identifier. Do not place verbatim source titles on the slide.
The first slide output contains an unwanted cover or second page	Instruct Manus to remove it and retain exactly one visible slide.
Text overflows or table rows are unreadable	Shorten the incident text, remove a metric, use fewer CVE rows, or increase the allocated area. Never reduce executive readability simply to retain weak content.

6. Reusable Run Folder and Evidence Structure

Use a folder or task label that makes each run distinct and auditable. The suggested naming convention is shown below.

Plain Text

```
cloud-threat-briefing-YYYY-MM
cloud-threat-briefing-YYYY-MM_to_YYYY-MM
```

For each run retain the following internal items. They do not have to be supplied to the Risk Committee unless requested.

File or artefact	Minimum content
Run manifest	Scope, timestamp, evidence cut-off, audience, output constraints and research streams.
Source register	All retained sources with publisher, URL, publication date and source tier.
Claim ledger	Claim ID, event date, factual assertion, 2LoD assessment and limitation.
Slide-content draft	Text that passed controlled-language checks before generation.
Slide source	Editable PowerPoint-compatible slide project.
Speaker notes	Internal evidence register , including prior-period correction statement.
Final slide	The presentation artefact delivered by Manus.

7. Minimum Evidence Register Template

Use this template in notes and internal working files. It provides traceability without overloading the slide.

Plain Text

Internal evidence register

Reporting period: [DD Month YYYY] to [DD Month YYYY]

Evidence cut-off: [DD Month YYYY, HH:MM Time Zone]

[Finding ID]

Event date: [date]

Disclosure date: [date]

Technology: [product/provider]

CVE / CVSS: [value or Not published]

Exploit status: [exactly as evidenced]

Source-supported fact: [one concise factual sentence]

Source URL: [URL]

Source tier: [Primary authoritative / Independent research / Contextual second]

2LoD assessment: [one concise internal assessment]

Limitation: [one evidence gap or scope limitation]

Prior-period correction: [None identified / description]

8. Working Example: Connected July-August 2026 Run

Use the connected-period prompt in Section 3, Step 1. The intended executive narrative is a **single pattern**: active exploitation across multiple privileged control planes, not an unconnected list of three CVEs.

The analytical chain should read as follows:

1. **Observed activity**: Retained events show active exploitation affecting CI/CD, collaboration and virtualisation administration.
2. **Operational vulnerability**: Each event reaches a management, delivery or collaboration control that can hold administrative capability, code artefacts, credentials or access to multiple workloads.
3. **Systemic pathway**: The shared privileged control plane is reused across several business services, creating common-mode reach if a central administrative node is compromised.
4. **Management decision**: Establish asset ownership, remove unnecessary internet reachability, apply exposure-led remediation, test containment and report exceptions through risk governance.

The resulting slide must not display July , August , 2026 , a source name, a URL, a citation, an audience label or a date. Those details remain in the Internal evidence register speaker notes.

9. Final Release Checklist

Use this short checklist before distributing the PowerPoint slide outside Manus.

- ☐ The personal skills are installed and were applied in the production task.
- ☐ The reporting period is explicit and correct.
- ☐ A run manifest, source register and claim ledger exist internally.
- ☐ Every material slide assertion has authoritative evidence.
- ☐ The slide retains only two to three material vectors or incidents.
- ☐ Every banking implication not directly evidenced is labelled as a 2LoD assessment.
- ☐ The visible slide contains exactly one page, with no sources, citations, dates, reporting-period label, audience label or footer.
- ☐ The CVE table has the four mandatory headings and no blank entries.
- ☐ Speaker notes contain the Internal evidence register and prior-period correction statement.
- ☐ Controlled-language checks passed on the draft, slide source and notes.
- ☐ The rendered slide has no clipping, overlap or unreadable content.
- ☐ The presented artefact can be exported as PowerPoint or PDF from Manus.

Release condition: Distribute only the slide artefact and, where required, its speaker notes. Retain the source register and claim ledger as internal audit evidence.

Appendix A - Recommended Prompt Sequence

Sequence	Copy-paste prompt purpose
1	Create and install the governance writing-control skill.
2	Create and install the monthly cloud briefing skill.
3	Confirm both skills are available in a fresh production task.
4	Run the standard or connected-period briefing prompt.
5	Require manifest, research streams and claim ledger before drafting.

6	Require the one-slide draft and language check.
7	Generate the PowerPoint slide and speaker notes.
8	Run final quality assurance, present and export.

The sequence is deliberately controlled: evidence precedes assessment, assessment precedes slide drafting, and drafting precedes presentation creation. This preserves auditability and prevents unsupported cyber-risk claims from reaching the Risk Committee.